

2012 (II)

17. Anna Hazare was awarded with the Padma Bhushan in recognition for

- (a) his war against corruption and launching Bhrashtachar Virodhi Jan Andolan
- (b) his service to the Indian Army
- (c) transforming a barren dry village called **Ralegan-Siddhi** in Maharashtra's Ahmednagar district into a model village of self-sufficiency, eco-friendly and harmony
- (d) his remarkable social service in the Adivasi areas of Bihar

18. Consider the following statements about Viswanathan Anand

- 1. He has won the World Chess Championship five times.
- 2. He is the first sports person to receive the Padma Vibhushan Award.
- 3. He is currently the Number 1 rating player on the FIDE Ratings.

Which of the statement(s) given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 3
- (b) 1 and 2
- (c) Only 2
- (d) All of these

19. Which one among the following nuclear capable countries has a declared No First Use Policy?

- (a) United States of America
- (b) People's Republic of China
- (c) Pakistan
- (d) Russia

20. The year 2002 Code of Conduct related to territorial and maritime dispute in the South China sea was signed between China and

- (a) Philippines
- (b) Vietnam
- (c) United States of America
- (d) ASEAN

21. In the year 2012, India undertook its largest military exercise since independence. This was named

- (a) Yuddh Abhyas
- (b) Rudra Akrosh
- (c) Sudarshan Shakti
- (d) Shoor Veer

22. The Indian Army undertook Operation Meghdoot to establish Indian control over

- (a) Sir Creek
- (b) Alksai Chin
- (c) Siachen Glacier
- (d) Drass Sector

23. The Partnership Council was launched the Strategic Partnership Agreement signed in the year 2011 between India and

- (a) United States
- (b) China
- (c) Maldives
- (d) Afghanistan

24. The Treaty on Integrated Development of Mahakali River was signed between India and

- (a) Pakistan
- (b) Nepal
- (c) Bhutan
- (d) Bangladesh

25. INS Vikramaditya, scheduled for induction into the Indian Navy soon, is the name given to

- (a) an aircraft carrier
- (b) a nuclear submarine
- (c) an amphibious assault vessel
- (d) a stealth ship

26. Farkhor Air Base, operated by the Indian Air Force, is situated in which one among the following countries?

- (a) Kazakhstan
- (b) Uzbekistan
- (c) Afghanistan
- (d) Tajikistan

27. Which one among the following statements about Mohammad Nasheed of Maldives is not correct?

- (a) He was the first President of Maldives to be elected through Multiparty elections
- (b) He became the President of Maldives in the year 2008
- (c) He was a strong advocate of the policies of longtime President Maumoon Abdul Gayoom
- (d) He has been advocating and promoting democracy and Human Rights in Maldives

2013 (I)

28. 'Global Dimming' means

- (a) gradual increase of the temperature of ionosphere
- (b) gradual loss of biodiversity hot spots
- (c) gradual reduction in the amount of global direct irradiance at the Earth surface
- (d) gradual increase in the melting of ice in polar regions

29. Consider the following statement
Rich countries have largely cheated the developing countries of the 30 billion dollars of funds. They had committed to transfer to the poor ones between 2010 and 2012.

Which one among the following relating to the above statement is not correct?

- (a) The above statement is a report out of Oxfam research
- (b) The developed nations only provided one-third of the total funding

- (c) Green Peace International stated that it is a 'false start' than a 'fast start'
- (d) Oxfam's research report says that levels of public climate finance are set to fall in the year 2013 compared to past 3 year

30. Which one among the following regarding G-20 is not correct?

- (a) A group of developed countries
- (b) An integral part of the United Nations
- (c) Outside the World Bank and IMF
- (d) An offshoot of G-7

31. Outstanding historian Eric Hobsbawm who expired on 1st October, 2012, has authored a large number of books. The title of his famous autobiography is

- (a) Bandits
- (b) Uncommon People : Resistance, Rebellion and Jazz
- (c) The New Century : In Conversation with Antonio Polito
- (d) Interesting Times : A 20th Century Life

32. Which one among the following was added in the year 2012 in the list of world heritage sites of the UNESCO?

- (a) Western Ghats
- (b) Agra Fort
- (c) Ajanta Caves
- (d) Meenakshi Temple

33. Which one among the following has been included as a parameter for the first time under the National Ambient Air Quality Standards (NAAQS) based on Central Pollution Control Board and IIT-Kanpur research, WHO guidelines and European Union limits and practices?

- (a) Sulphur dioxide
- (b) Oxides of nitrogen
- (c) Ozone
- (d) Carbon monoxide

34. Consider the following statements about Malala Yousafzai

- 1. In November, 2012, she was awarded with the Bravery Award by the World Peace and Prosperity Foundation.
- 2. The United Nations declared 10th November as 'Malala Day' in honour of her contribution in the field of girls' education.

Which of the statement(s) given above is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1
- (b) Only 2
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

- 35.** Why was Kaushik Basu, the ex-economic advisor to the Prime Minister of India, in news recently? He was appointed as
 (a) the President of the IMF
 (b) the President of the World Bank
 (c) the Economic Advisor of the United Nations
 (d) the Chief Economist of the World Bank
- 36.** Which one among the following statements about Grigori Perelman is not correct?
 (a) He is a genius from Russia
 (b) He rejected the offer of professorship in Princeton and Stanford University
 (c) He works in the area of cosmology
 (d) He has refused to accept the 'Fields Medal' and the 'Millennium Prize' recently
- 37.** Mention the odd one out.
 (a) Didier Drogba
 (b) Oliver Kahn
 (c) Lionel Messi
 (d) Cristiano Ronaldo
- 38.** Which one among the following countries initiated the process of Fourth Wave of Democratic Transition?
 (a) Libya (b) Afghanistan
 (c) Tunisia (d) Morocco
- 39.** The *Rohingya* are the minorities of
 (a) South Africa (b) Canada
 (c) Myanmar (d) Bhutan
- 40.** The President of India on 20th November, 2012 released a commemorative postage stamp on the occasion of Ramgopal Maheshwari's birth centenary year celebration. Which of the following statements regarding Ramgopal Maheshwari is/are correct?
 1. He is regarded as a doyen of journalism in India.
 2. He was a trusted aid of Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose and helped him in mobilising the forces of Indian National Army in Kohima.
Select the correct answer using the codes given below.
 (a) Only 1
 (b) Only 2
 (c) Both 1 and 2
 (d) Neither 1 nor 2
- 41.** During the last part of November 2012, there was a severe fire accident which took away the lives of more than hundred people in Bangladesh. The accident occurred inside a
 (a) textile factory
 (b) jute factory
 (c) polythene manufacturing factory
 (d) cement factory
- 42.** Who among the following was declared as the immediate future President of China in the 18th National Congress of the Communist Party of China held in November, 2012?
 (a) Zhang Dejiang (b) Xi Jinping
 (c) Liu Yunshan (d) Li Keqiang
- 43.** Some atheists, skeptics and non-believers called to celebrate '25th December' as *Newtonmas* Day instead of observing 'Christmas Day'. The reason they propose that
 (a) both Isaac Newton and Jesus Christ were great
 (b) Isaac Newton was born on 25th December
 (c) 'Skeptic Society' was founded on 25th December
 (d) Isaac Newton was a deep believer of Christianity
- 44.** Which one among the following statements about Barack Obama is not correct?
 (a) In the year 2012, he was elected as the President of USA for the second time, defeating the republican candidate Mitt Romney
 (b) He is the first African-American President of USA
 (c) He is the first Democratic President since Franklin D Roosevelt to twice win the majority of the popular vote in USA presidential election
 (d) He is the only American President who won the Nobel Peace Prize
- 45.** The Pulitzer Prize for fiction in the year 2013 has been announced for the book
 (a) 'The Orphan Master's Son' authored by Adam Johnson
 (b) 'What We Talk About When We Talk About Anne Frank' authored by Nathan Englander
 (c) 'The Snow Child' authored by Eowyn Ivey
 (d) None of the above
- 46.** Which one among the following Indian scientists has been awarded the '2012 award for International Science Cooperation' by Chinese Academy of Sciences?
 (a) KS Srinivasan
 (b) Sree Kumar Banerjee
 (c) DD Bhawalkar
 (d) CNR Rao
- 47.** Which legendary actor has been awarded the Dada Saheb Phalke Award, 2012?
 (a) Shashi Kapoor
 (b) Pran Krishan Sikand
 (c) Anupam Kher
 (d) Soumitra Chatterjee
- 48.** Consider the following statements
 1. Rafael Nadal won Men's Singles French Open Tennis Tournament-2013, defeating Spanish compatriot David Ferrer.
 2. This is Nadal's maiden French Open title.
Which of the statements given above is/ are correct?
 (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
 (c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2
- 49.** Who among the following is the author of the book, 'Sachin : Born to Bat—The Journey of Cricket's Ultimate Centurian'?
 (a) Khalid AH Ansari (b) Boria Majumdar
 (c) Kiran Nagarkar (d) Ed Hawkins
- 50.** Who among the following was not associated with the art of painting?
 (a) Abanindranath Tagore
 (b) Abdur Rahman Chaghatai
 (c) Nandalal Bose
 (d) Satish Chandra Mukherjee
- 51.** 'Silent Spring', considered by many as one among the greatest science books of all time, is written by Rachel Carson. The book deals with
 (a) wildlife preservation
 (b) protection of the environment
 (c) pollution of the water body
 (d) None of the above
- 52.** On March 8, 2013 President of India has released a commemorative postage stamp on late Sahir Ludhianvi at Rashtrapati Bhawan. Ludhianvi was
 (a) the translator of the Omar Khayyam's Rubaiyat into Hindi
 (b) an eminent social activist of India
 (c) one of the top Urdu dramatists and actor
 (d) widely acclaimed as a people's poet

2013 (II)

53. VS Ramadevi, who died in Bengaluru on April 17, 2013, was the Governor of Karnataka and Himachal Pradesh. What was more specific about her? She was the

- (a) Governor of the two States simultaneously
- (b) only female Chief Election Commissioner of India
- (c) only female Indian High Commissioner to United Kingdom
- (d) Governor of Reserve Bank of India

54. In April, 2013, an agreement was signed, between India and a country which extends the use of training and exercise facilities in India to the army of that country for a further period of five years from August, 2013. Sort out the country from among the following

- (a) Malaysia (b) Singapore
- (c) Myanmar (d) Bangladesh

55. The Saudi Arabia Government has recently decided to strictly implement a law called Nitaqat law. As a result

- (a) 10% jobs in Saudi should be reserved for Saudi nationals
- (b) 50% jobs in Saudi should be reserved for Saudi nationals
- (c) A foreigner will be allowed to work in Saudi Arabia for a maximum period of 10 years
- (d) 'Foreigner's' job contracts in Saudi Arabia will be on year to year basis

56. With which one among the following countries, did India sign a Memorandum of Understanding on Cooperation in the field of Election Management and Administration (on April 12, 2013 in New Delhi)?

- (a) Japan (b) Mauritius
- (c) Thailand (d) Sri Lanka

57. Which of the following statements about India-China relations is/are correct?

- 1. 'Look East' policy is a vital part of the relationship.
- 2. There is an active defence exchange programme.
- 3. Institutional mechanism to share international waters is in place.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 1 and 2
- (c) Only 1 (d) 2 and 3

58. Well known film 'Chittagong', directed by Bedabrata Pain, is mainly based on the life of

- (a) Subodh Roy
- (b) Binod Bihari Chowdhury
- (c) Preetilata Wadedar
- (d) Ganesh Ghosh

59. British Scientist Robert Edwards, winner of Nobel Prize for Physiology and Medicine, passed away on April 10, 2013. What was so important about him?

- (a) He was the pioneer in the field of cloning
- (b) He led the human genome project
- (c) His pioneering works led to the birth of the first test tube baby
- (d) He discovered the artificial heart

60. Consider the following statements

- 1. ISRO has recently given clearance for using the frequency from KU band for using the satellite for internet in trains in India.
- 2. KU frequency range is allocated to be exclusively used by satellite communication system.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
- (c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

61. The 'Thomas Cup' is associated with

- (a) Table Tennis (b) Lawn Tennis
- (c) Badminton (d) Billiards

62. Which one among the following was the main demand of the '2013 Shahbag Protests'?

- (a) Employment for all above eighteen years
- (b) Equal rights for men and women
- (c) Capital punishment for those convicted of crimes against humanity during 1971, Bangladesh Liberation War
- (d) Introduction of Urdu and Arabic languages as compulsory subjects in primary education

2014 (I)

63. Consider the following statements about UN Frontline Workers Global Leadership Award

- 1. Martha Dodray, an auxiliary nurse and midwife from Bihar, was conferred the Award in the year 2013.

2. Martha Dodray was awarded for her dedicated service in the bird flu affected areas of India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
- (c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

64. Carefully read the following passage and identify the person referred to in that

Her best known works are *The Golden Notebook*, *Memoirs of a Survivor* and *The Summer Before the Dark*. She was the oldest recipient of the Nobel Prize in Literature.

- (a) Alice Munro (b) Doris Lessing
- (c) Herta Muller (d) Elfriede Jelinek

65. Which of the following statements about Prof. CNR Rao is/are correct?

- 1. He is considered to be an international authority in solid-state and structural chemistry.
- 2. He is the first Indian to reach the H-index of 100, reflecting the economy of the body of his published research work.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
- (c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

66. Rachel Carson's famous book, *Silent Spring* refers to

- (a) geology of terrain where river originates
- (b) ecology and degradation of a hot spring due to excessive tourism
- (c) biodiversity of an unknown terrain rich in flora and fauna
- (d) the death of songbirds due to eating insects poisoned with pesticides

67. The concept of hegemony is used to understand the capacity to 'manufacture consent'. Here, hegemony implies

- 1. class ascendancy in ideological spheres.
- 2. deploying ideological resources to shape behaviour of weaker states/powers.
- 3. provision of global public goods by a dominant power.
- 4. military dominance in relative and absolute terms.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 and 3
- (c) Only 4 (d) Only 1

68. Heena Sidhu, who recently won a World Cup Gold Medal for India, is associated with

- (a) shooting (b) archery
(c) weightlifting (d) boxing

69. Internal Security Academy is located at

- (a) Nashik (b) Mount Abu
(c) Hyderabad (d) Pune

70. Indian Navy commissioned its first Advanced Light Helicopter Squadron at Kochi in November 2013. What is the name of the helicopter?

- (a) Chetak (b) Dhruv
(c) Rudra (d) Cheetah

71. Consider the following statements regarding Indian Ocean Rim Association

1. The 13th Council of Ministers meeting of the Association was held in November 2013 in Perth.
2. India was elected Chair of the Association from 2013 to 2015.
3. There are twenty member nations in the Association.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) 1 and 3 (d) All of these

72. Match the following

List I (Author)	List II (Concept/Book)
A. Hobbes	1. Natural Law
B. Rousseau	2. 'Might is Right'
C. Locke	3. Discourse on Inequality
D. Adam Smith	4. The Wealth of Nations

Codes

A B C D	A B C D
(a) 2 1 3 4	(b) 2 3 1 4
(c) 4 3 1 2	(d) 4 1 3 2

73. Non-military Confidence Building Measures (CBMs) in a peace process include

1. people to people contact across borders.
2. literary and cultural interaction under government and non-governmental agencies.
3. increase in travel facilities.
4. joint initiatives to tackle common socio-economic problems.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- (a) 2 and 3 (b) 1 and 3
(c) 2 and 4 (d) All of these

74. The Union Ministry of Environment and Forest recently approved in principle a proposal for Western Ghats development prepared K Kasturirangan-led panel. The panel has recommended a ban on development activities in around 60000 sq km ecologically sensitive area spread over

- (a) Gujarat, Andhra Pradesh, Tamil Nadu, Maharashtra, Kerala and Karnataka
(b) Gujarat, Maharashtra, Goa, Karnataka, Kerala and Tamil Nadu
(c) Odisha, Maharashtra, Goa, Kerala, Andhra Pradesh and Tamil Nadu
(d) Karnataka, Odisha, Gujarat, Kerala, Maharashtra and Tamil Nadu

75. Which of the following nations were recently suspended with regard to the voting rights by the UNESCO for not paying their dues to it?

1. USA 2. Israel 3. Iran 4. Iraq

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- (a) 3 and 4 (b) 1 and 2
(c) 2 and 3 (d) All of these

2014 (II)

76. Which of the following is/are department(s) in Ministry of Defence?

1. Department of Defence
2. Department of Defence Research and Development
3. Department of Defence Production
4. Department of Defence Finance

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 1, 2 and 3
(c) 2, 3 and 4 (d) Only 1

77. Which of the following is/are Paramilitary Force(s) of India?

1. Indian Coast Guard
2. Assam Rifles
3. Directorate General of Resettlement

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 1 and 3
(c) Only 2 (d) 1 and 2

78. 'Garuda-V', concluded recently, is a joint exercise between the Air Forces of India and

- (a) Japan (b) Canada
(c) Russia (d) France

79. 'Arihant' is the name of

- (a) an infantry combat vehicle
(b) a ballistic missile
(c) an attack helicopter
(d) a nuclear-powered submarine

80. Consider the following statements about GAGAN (GPS Aided Geo Augmented Navigation) system:

1. It offers free enhanced satellite navigation signals over India which are ten times more precise than GPS.
2. It was developed jointly by ISRO and NASA

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

81. Andaman and Nicobar Command is

- (a) a Command of the Indian Army
(b) a regional Command of the Indian Coast Guard
(c) an integrated theatre Command operating directly under the Chiefs of Staff Committee
(d) a joint Command of the Indian Navy and the Indian Air Force

82. Which one among the following is not a Command of the Indian Army?

- (a) South-Western Command
(b) South-Eastern Command
(c) Army Training Command
(d) Central Command

83. Master Chief Petty Officer is a rank in the

- (a) Indian Navy
(b) Military Engineering Service
(c) Army Aviation Corps
(d) Indian Air Force

84. 'Project Seabird' is connected with

- (a) greenfield naval base at West coast of India
(b) anti-pirate operation at Somalia
(c) Indian Navy's island development project
(d) shipyard in Kutch district, Gujarat

85. Consider the following statements about 'Project Mausam':

1. The project was launched in June, 2014 by the Ministry of External Affairs.
2. At the macro level, the project aims to re-connect and re-establish communications between countries of the Indian Ocean world, which would lead to an enhanced understanding of cultural values and concerns; while at the micro level, the focus is on understanding national cultures in their regional maritime milieu.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

86. Consider the following statements about Star Alliance network:

1. Established in the year 1997, it is the leading global airline network with the highest number of member airlines, daily flights, destinations and countries flown to.
2. Air India has recently joined the Star Alliance in a bid to garner more revenue.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

87. Stepwell Rani-ki-Vav was approved as a World Heritage Site by the UNESCO recently. It is located at

- (a) Rajasthan
(b) Gujarat
(c) Madhya Pradesh
(d) Maharashtra

88. Consider the following statements

1. World Vitiligo Day is observed on June 25 every year.
2. Vitiligo is a progressive skin disease.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1
(b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

89. Novak Djokovic, who won the Men's Wimbledon tennis tournament 2014, is from

- (a) Serbia (b) Spain
(c) Switzerland (d) England

90. Consider the following statements about Pragati missile system of India

1. It is a short range solid fuel missile system.
2. It has all weather day and night operational launch capability.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1
(b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

91. Match the following

List I (Founder/First Director)	List II (Premier Research Institute)
A. Vikram Sarabhai	1. Indian Statistical Institute
B. Homi J. Bhabha	2. Jawaharlal Nehru Centre for Advanced Scientific Research
C. CNR Rao	3. Tata Institute of Fundamental Research
D. PC Mahalanobis	4. Physical Research Laboratory

Codes

- | | |
|-------------|-------------|
| A B C D | A B C D |
| (a) 4 3 2 1 | (b) 4 2 3 1 |
| (c) 1 3 2 4 | (d) 1 2 3 4 |

2015 (I)

92. Notification regarding commencement or cessation of a State of war is the responsibility of

- (a) Ministry of Home Affairs
(b) Ministry of Defence
(c) Ministry of External Affairs
(d) None of these

93. Which of the following statement(s) about caste movements in early 20th century Kerala is/are false?

1. Kerala's first modern novel *Indulekha* attacked the social dominance of Nambudiri Brahmins in Kerala.
2. CV Raman Pillai's novel *Marthanda Varma* was written against the exploitation of peasants by Nair landlords.
3. Sree Narayana Guru was one of the founders of the Sree Narayana Dharma Paripalana Yogam that was engaged in the upliftment of the Ezhavas in Kerala.
4. Dr Palpu, the first Ezhava graduate, was one of the founders of the Sree Narayana Dharma Paripalana Yogam that was engaged in the upliftment of the Ezhavas in Kerala.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

- (a) Only 1 (b) 1 and 3
(c) Only 2 (d) 2 and 4

94. Which one among the following was the theme of the International Day for the Preservation of the Ozone Layer 2014?

- (a) Ozone Day—A Healthy Atmosphere, The Future We Want
(b) Protecting Our Atmosphere for Generations to Come
(c) HCFC Phase Out : A Unique Opportunity
(d) Ozone Layer Protection : The Mission Goes On

95. What was the claim to fame of Dr Dwarkanath Kotnis?

- (a) He provided succour to the poor
(b) He set-up hospitals in the difficult to reach regions of India
(c) He was a leading Indian nationalist
(d) He laid down his life providing medical help to the Eighth Route Army

96. Which among the following teams won the Duleep Trophy Cricket Tournament 2014?

- (a) East Zone
(b) Central Zone
(c) West Zone
(d) South Zone

97. What was the common element among (i) GD Birla, (ii) Ambalal Sarabhai and (iii) Walchand Hirachand?

- (a) They were leading members of the socialist movement in India
(b) They were Indian industrialists
(c) They were nationalist leaders
(d) All of the above

98. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. 'Yudh Abhyas 2014' was an India-USA military exercise.
2. 'Yudh Abhyas 2014' was conducted in Himachal Pradesh.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

99. The Central Industrial Security Force is under the administration control of which of the following ministries?

- (a) Ministry Heavy Industries and Public Enterprises
(b) Headquarters of the Integrated Joint Staff
(c) Ministry of Home Affairs
(d) PMO